

CAMPAIGN MANUAL

MTGROGUE

GM's Guide

Prepare, run, and adjudicate MTGRogue

Public Release v1.0

Synchronized with the MTGRogue v1.0 assistants

Public edition without hidden-progression spoilers

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01 The GM's Role

The GM organizes the campaign, prepares opponents, and keeps the screens moving in the correct order. The GM does not need to improvise probabilities or the economy: the assistant stores the state and resolves draws. The main responsibilities are checking that a result is playable and following the fallback options shown when external data is unavailable.

GM responsibility	Assistant responsibility
prepare decklists and play materials	track gold, gems, lives, minimum deck size, and progression
play or pilot the opponent	draw the Command Zone, rewards, events, and shops
check the practical legality of a list	apply filters, rarities, costs, and limits
export backups regularly	store local state and provide fallbacks

02 Prepare the Campaign

Initial card pool

Category	Quantity
Mono-colored commons	100 per color
Colorless commons	50
Two-color commons	5 per color pair
Tapped dual lands	3 per color pair
Basic lands	unlimited

Campaign files

- MTGRogue_Campaign_Start_Assistant_v1.0.html creates the initial permanent card pool.
- MTGRogue_Deck_Draw_Assistant_v1.0.html prepares opponents for the encounter sequence.
- MTGRogue_Run_Assistant_v1.0.html is the source of truth during play.
- Export a JSON backup after every session and before any important update.

Companion software and websites

Tool	Function	Setup
Moxfield	Mirror the player's permanent card pool in Collection and build Freeform lists.	Optional: create a dedicated account with an initially empty collection. Add only cards from the MTGRogue permanent card pool.
Cockatrice	Play encounters and import player and opponent lists.	Install the client, run Oracle to download card data, then import decklists.

Why use an empty Moxfield account?

Moxfield Collection mirrors the permanent card pool. If the account already contains the player's real collection, searches and manual deckbuilding can no longer distinguish cards earned in MTGRogue.

Initial settings

The defaults are designed to work without configuration: duplicate prevention enabled, Magic Only set to All Cards, and a target of 35 permanent-card-pool cards for Instant Deckbuilding. The interface opens in English by default. French Mode depends on the group, and Magic Only can be disabled separately for Instant Deckbuilding.

03 Command Zone and Deckbuilding

Deck rules

- Commander singleton; no commander damage; a mulligan procedure suited to one-on-one play.
- 99 main-deck cards with one commander, or 98 with two Command Zone cards; permanent floor of 60.
- For each color in the commander's color identity, at least 5 nonland cards include that color in their mana cost or color identity.
- Cards gained during the run may move into or out of the deck at any time outside combat.

Freeform Deckbuilding

The player builds the list manually, usually in Moxfield or another deckbuilding tool, using the initial collection, permanent card pool, and freely available basic lands. The GM checks only deck size, singleton, and color identity.

Instant Deckbuilding

After Command Zone selection, the assistant can produce a ready-to-play deck. Mixed mode combines the permanent card pool with rented cards. Card Pool Only mode uses EDHREC to rank owned cards but adds no absent nonbasic spell or land. The generated base is not freely rebuilt; cards gained during the run remain exchangeable outside combat.

EDHREC search order:

1. Average Deck — Bracket 2 — Budget.
2. Average Deck — Bracket 2.
3. General Average Deck — Budget.
4. General Average Deck.
5. If no profile exists: show an error and grant a free Command Zone reroll.

Why some owned cards rank highly

Rented cards come only from the first Average Deck profile found. Owned cards are cross-referenced against other profiles, Cube Cobra Elo, and combo information. The Power Nine has priority, and combo packages in which the player has already invested are favored.

04 Instant Deckbuilding Mana Plan

- Reference: 38 lands for a 99-card deck, scaled proportionally as the deck shrinks.
- Each of the five original Moxen replaces one land; Black Lotus does not replace a land.
- A card with a strict {C} requirement is used only in a fully colorless deck.
- A fetch land or search spell is kept only when the deck contains a target with the required land type.
- Five-color-producing lands are avoided in mono-colored or colorless decks when basics or suitable utility lands are preferable.
- Urborg, Tomb of Yawgmoth requires black identity; Yavimaya, Cradle of Growth requires green identity.
- Paliano, the High City is never proposed.

Reduced decks

The assistant caps the requested owned-card target so the final list, including its proportional basic-land allocation, fits the current minimum deck size. Deck reduction therefore removes excess suggestions rather than producing an oversized list.

05 Filters and Languages

Duplicate prevention

Ordinary draws avoid cards already in the permanent card pool or already gained during the run. Commanders are not filtered. English and French card names are retained as aliases when necessary.

Magic Only

The default profile accepts all cards. Other profiles can exclude Universes Beyond according to the group's preference. A separate setting can disable Magic Only for Instant Deckbuilding so an existing card pool containing those cards remains useful.

French Mode

Mode	Behavior
Disabled	no card-language preference
Moderate	prefer a reliable French printing; otherwise keep English
Strict	require a usable French printing; an English Power Nine exception can be enabled

For a set booster, the assistant preserves the original set and rarity, then may display an equivalent French printing. If no compatible card can be found, a free replacement booster is offered.

06 The Run Loop

1. Start: receive the indicated tool and prepare the first opponent.
2. Pre-Combat: apply active effects, select any contract, and lock the list.
3. Combat: play the game; do not change the deck while it is being resolved.
4. Victory: record gold, then resolve the reward, event, and shop in the displayed order.
5. Outside combat: freely integrate cards gained during the run.
6. Defeat or completion: resolve End of Run, the permanent card pool, and gems.

Tools

Timing	Possible tools	Purpose
Before combat	Reconnaissance, Scouting, Toss, Sabotage, Forced Mulligan	gain information or disrupt the opponent
During opening hands	Known Hand, Protected Mulligan, Stable Hand	secure the player's opening
After a defeat	Best-of-Three	grant a rematch according to the effect

Contracts

A contract is a voluntary drawback applied to the player for one encounter. Winning despite the handicap adds the displayed gold bonus to the normal reward. Refusing all contracts has no penalty.

Contracts do not gain levels. They unlock automatically and separately for each exact boss: one previous victory unlocks Minor, two unlock Major, and three unlock Extreme. At Pre-Combat, the assistant draws a random drawback in every unlocked tier. Contract Stacking allows more than one contract in the same encounter.

Example

The player has already defeated Current Standard twice in earlier runs. The next time that exact boss appears, Minor and Major contracts are available. The player may choose neither, choose one, or stack them if the skill allows it.

Opponent Commander (Extreme contract)

The GM chooses a legendary creature from the opponent decklist to serve as its commander. If the list contains no legendary creature, the GM chooses any commander. The opponent deck ignores commander color-identity restrictions and may still contain four copies in the main deck plus the commander in the Command Zone, for five total copies. The Run Assistant repeats this rule on the Combat screen whenever the contract is selected.

07 Rewards, Events, and Shops

The assistant displays available choices and applies costs. The GM should not repeatedly relaunch a failed request: use the partial result, free replacement, or manual field provided on the screen.

Encounters to watch

- Cartographer: choose a compatible color combination; the revealed lands produce exactly those colors, with colorless mana possibly in addition.
- Hunter: reveal 5 cards from the defeated deck and choose 1 for free; use the displayed fallback if none are compatible.
- Counterfeiter: record the copied card; the active effect keeps its name.
- Collector and Alchemist: Command Zone cards can never be removed as a cost.
- Demonic Pact: choose a reward; the next boss begins with a random Magic emblem drawn by the assistant. The Ring is excluded.
- Surgeon: permanent deck reduction costs 750 gold and truly lowers the deck minimum, never below 60. Extraction removes a card from the permanent card pool only.

Scryfall loading

Changing shops during a draw should cancel the previous request. Wait until the new screen is stable before drawing again. When a source returns a temporary error, use the retry button or free fallback instead of opening several draws.

08 End of Run and Progression

At End of Run, the player normally selects 3 gained cards, increased by Inheritance. Cards already owned are disabled. Once the limit is reached, other boxes are greyed out and become available again after a selection is removed. Command Zone cards are eligible for the permanent card pool.

Gold and gems

- Maximum interest is 30%.
- Maximum gold retention between runs is 40%.
- Gems purchase the visible skills in the Skill Tree.
- Exact progression and skill values are listed in Reference and Appendices.

What the public edition does not reveal

Do not anticipate unlocks that are not described in these documents. The assistant reveals them at the intended point in the campaign.

09 Adjudication and Troubleshooting

Situation	GM decision
external source unavailable	follow the interface fallback; never charge the player for an empty result
no EDHREC profile	grant the free reroll offered
partial draw	keep compatible cards if the screen allows it
uncertain backup	export before any reset; re-import the latest reliable copy
interface and rule disagree	apply the intent of this edition and the value stored in the save

Reference and Appendices contains a more detailed checklist for imports, double-faced cards, localized images, shops, and Instant Deckbuilding.